Problem Identification

Amazon Music Prime first launched in 2007 is an online service that offers qualified Amazon Prime members unlimited, ad-free access to on-demand streaming of selected playlists and Stations, as well as millions of songs and albums, all at no extra charge.

Spotify is also a digital music streaming service. It gives you instant access to its vast online library of music and podcasts. It has been nearly 15 years since Spotify first launched in 2008. and today the platform is the most popular music streaming services.

Feature Comparison

Features	Amazon Music	Spotify
1. Download Music	Yes	Yes
2. Works on many platforms	Yes	Yes
3. Discover Music	Yes	Yes
4. Spotify Connect	No	Yes
5. Friend Activity	No	Yes
6. Lyrics with songs	No	Yes
7. Sharing Music	Yes	Yes
8. Daily Mixes/Podcasts	Yes	Yes
9. Create Collaborative Playlist	No	Yes
10. Private Sessions	No	Yes

Spotify are currently the kings of music streaming with more than 70 million paying subscribers (January 2018). Spotify, in my opinion, do have the best features of all the platforms on the market right now. It's going to take a lot to knock them off that top spot, but possible and Amazon have as good a chance as any of the platforms if more engaging features are used in their platform.

User Research

The type of users of the music streaming platform can be divided into Upper class users, middle class (the plan switching users), lower class users and the artist/distributors which publish their music on the platform.

Types of User Personas

Upper Class – Users who want to pay money to listen the best quality music and use all the best features on the platform

Middle Class - Users who switches between plans and doesn't stick to premium for a long time.

Lower Class – Users who are only their to listen to music and use any service or feature provided only it its free.

Artists/Distributors – Users who create and distribute music to make money on the platform.

Current Plans Comparison

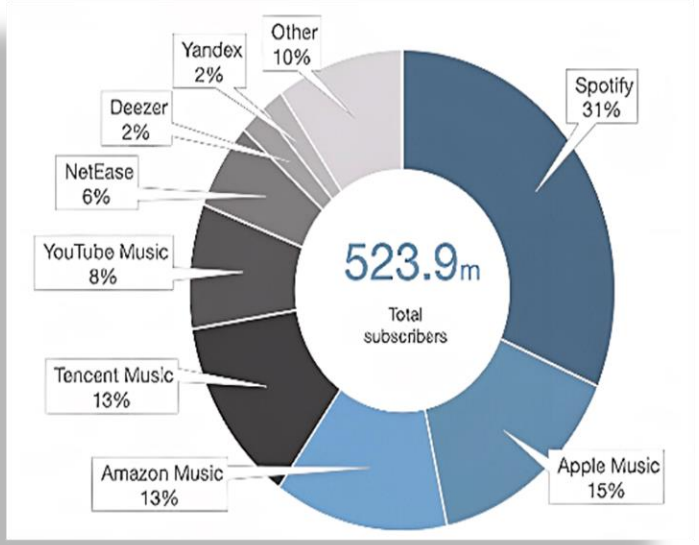
Platform	Free Plan	IndividualPremium	FamilyPlan	StudentPlan	Others
Spotify Premium	Yes	$9.99/month	$15.99/month	$4.99/month	Premium Duo: $12.99/month
Amazon Music Unlimited	Yes	Non-Prime: $9.99/month Prime: $8.99/month	$15.99/month or $159/year	Non-Prime: $4.99/month Prime: $0.99/month	Single Device Plan: $4.99/month

Both paid plans offer the same following features:

- Ad-free, on-demand playback
- Full access to all music and podcast content
- Option to download songs for offline listening
- Option to import local files from your computer

- **Assumption** – US Data is considered for the analysis.

Market Research



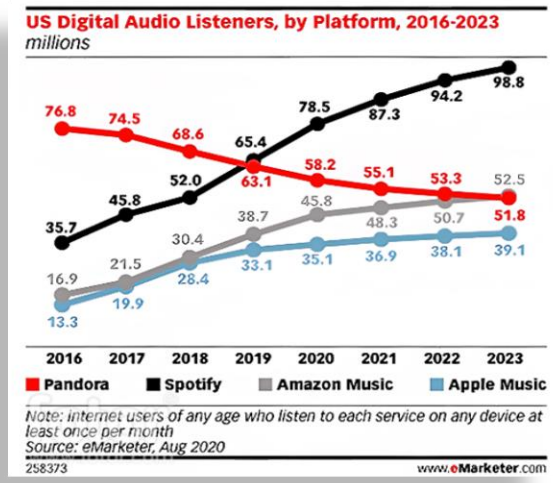
Based on Midia's claim that there were 523.9 million total music streaming subscribers in Q2 2021.

Spotify was the largest music streaming service in the world as of the second quarter of 2021 with a market share of 31 percent

Apple Music in second place at 15 percent, and Amazon Music and Tencent Music each tied at third with 13 percent apiece.

According to Midia, the music streaming market is continuing to grow, and increased by 26.4 percent to the second quarter of last year.

Although Spotify's commanding lead means it's unlikely to be overtaken anytime soon, Midia notes that its market share dropped from 33 percent in Q2 2020 to 31 percent in Q2 2021, and its growth was outperformed by Amazon and YouTube Music.

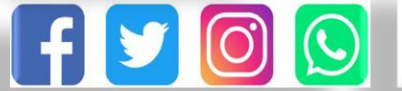


Amazon Music is on track to surpass Pandora in monthly listeners by 2023. As of 2020, Amazon Music already has 45.8 million listeners. That is 2.5 million listeners more than the previous forecast. More people downloaded music streaming apps during the pandemic. Amazon Music subscriptions grew by 104% year-over-year in 2020

Pain Points of Users

Bio: Yashu is an corporate employee who works longs hours but also goes to gym daily and needs to listen to songs during his workout sessions. He also likes to discover new music according to his taste.
Pain Point: As Ram goes to work he doesn't get time to curate a playlist accordingly. He needs some automatic feature that will create a playlist according to his taste. Amazon music currently doesn't provide this feature.

Bio: Pratham wants to know what songs their friends like and which artists they follow.
Pain Point: There is no current feature on the Amazon music that allows to connect to the social media friends and track their activities.



Bio: Guru like to learn the lyrics of the song he like when he listens it. Also he like to sing along simultaneously as he listens the song.
Pain Point: Currently Amazon music platform doesn't provide any such features of lyrics or Karaoke versions of the song to sing along

Bio: Shubham is curious and wants to know which are the songs currently trending globally and the top songs in different countries.
Pain Point: There is a basic feature to show popular trending songs on the basis of language, but there is no clear indication that which are song are trending globally or for some specific country.

Bio: Manya is a big fan of some artist and singers and wants to know about their new music status on how well they are doing on the platform and how many people like the artist's songs. Also Manya wants to know more about their favourite artist by accessing their social media pages on various platforms.
Pain Point: Currently there are no feature on that would show the stats Shyama wants. Only total number of followers can be seen currently on the platform

Features Recommended

Analysis from the market research:

- The social aspects of Amazon Music are one area where it appears to be behind.
- Amazon is already utilising their algorithms for recommendations well within their music platform, but they are still lagging behind competitors in terms of social features.
- There is less of an emphasis on followers and community, and sharing your music with pals is difficult.
- Amazon needs to improve its user-generated content strategy if it wants to dominate the industry.
- One of the main draws to Spotify and now a key component are user-generated playlists. To differentiate itself, Amazon needs to develop its own user-generated content strategy.

On the Basis of the analysis following features can be suggested to increase the market share of Amazon music platform:

- **Artist Music Profile Statistics** - Artists statistics include number of monthly or weekly listeners total and for each song. Similarly number of likes for each song, rank of the artist globally and country-wise can also be shown.
- **Amazon Music Chart** – Feature to show weekly trending charts for both globally and country-wise can be incorporated.
- **Playlist Enhancer/Curator** - Feature like enhance button to suggest song according to current playlist in order to add more songs to it. Option to automatically create a playlist according to user history for certain mood or type of music.
- **Official Video Of Songs** – Feature to play full video or a part of video like reel alongside the song.
- **Amazon Music Lyrics** – Feature to show lyrics with the song playing. Karaoke mode option to sing with song tune.
- **Social Media Connecter** – Option to connect social media details to connect with friends on different social media platforms in order to track activity, collaborate to make playlist, share music

Feature Prioritization

Using RICE framework to evaluate

Feature	Reach	Impact	Confidence	Effort	Rice Score
1.Artist Music Profile Statistics	7	3	70	2	7.35
2.Playlist Enhancer/Curator	8	4	90	4	7.20
3. Amazon Music Chart	6	2	70	2	4.20
4.Official Video Of Songs	5	2	60	2	6.00
5. Amazon Music Lyrics	6	3	70	4	3.15
6. Social Media Connecter	9	4	80	3	9.60

We will calculate the RICE score as follows:

$$\frac{\text{Reach} \times \text{Impact} \times \text{Confidence}}{\text{Effort}} = \text{RICE SCORE}$$

On the basis of the RICE score calculated, Top 3 features we should consider are as follows:

- **Social Media Connecter**
- **Artist Music Profile Statistics**
- **Playlist Enhancer/Curator**

Assumptions – Reach max score is 10 points, Impact and effort max score is 5 points and Confidence is out of 100 percent

#1 Social Media Connector

This feature functionality consists of:

- A feature button Social at the Profile Page (refer Prototype slide) . After clicking this button a popup appears giving options to connect from different platforms.
- A Friend Activity Bar similar to Spotify that will show the songs currently playing/last played by recent some of the friends.
- This feature will give access friends to check out the user created playlist and will allow to them to suggest/add songs to it (if allowed by user).

#2 Playlist Enhancer/Curator

This feature functionality consists of:

- A feature button titled 'Enhancer' to all the user generated playlist that will add songs according to user's taste and the songs already there in playlist.
- A feature button stating creating a new playlist by selecting a particular a genre of music.

#3 Artist Music Profile Stats

This feature functionality consists of:

- A banner showing total number of total number of monthly listeners. .
- A feature button to know more stats of the artist like global rank, country-wise rank, total likes and likes for each song as well.
- A banner providing links to the artists social media pages on different platforms.

Success Metrics

- ✓ **Number of Application Downloads:** Total Increase/Decrease in downloads of Amazon music application on Play/App store.
- ✓ **Monthly Active Users/Daily Active Users:** Total change in MAU and DAU can be monitored after the feature launch
- ✓ **Session Length:** Total Increase in average session length per active users.
- ✓ **Retention rate and Bounce Rate:** Change in retention and bounce rate on the pages where new features are present.
- ✓ **Number of clicks on the create playlist button:** Total number of new playlist created by clicking create playlist feature button
- ✓ **Number of clicks on the Enhance playlist button:** Total number of new playlist enhanced by clicking enhance playlist feature button
- ✓ **Number of Views on Artist Profile Page:** Total change in number of visit to Artist profile page on the platform.
- ✓ **Total Clicks on 'More Stats' button:** Total number of clicks on more stats button and also difference in number of profile views and this total.
- ✓ **Total Clicks on Social media buttons:** Total number of clicks on social media handle buttons provided on Artists page.
- ✓ **Times song played from Friend Activity Bar:** Total clicks on song link from friend activity bar helps to evaluate engagement through the feature.
- ✓ **Number of Collaborative songs suggested:** Number of songs suggested and added through suggestion by friend on public playlist
- ✓ **Average number of songs played per session**

Using Heart analysis the feature proposed can be used to measure user experience. Following are the features responsible for providing for various user experience:

Happiness : playlist enhancer , Amazon music lyrics

Engagement : playlist Enhancer, music charts , official video, music lyrics , social media

Adoption : music profile, music charts , music lyrics , social media

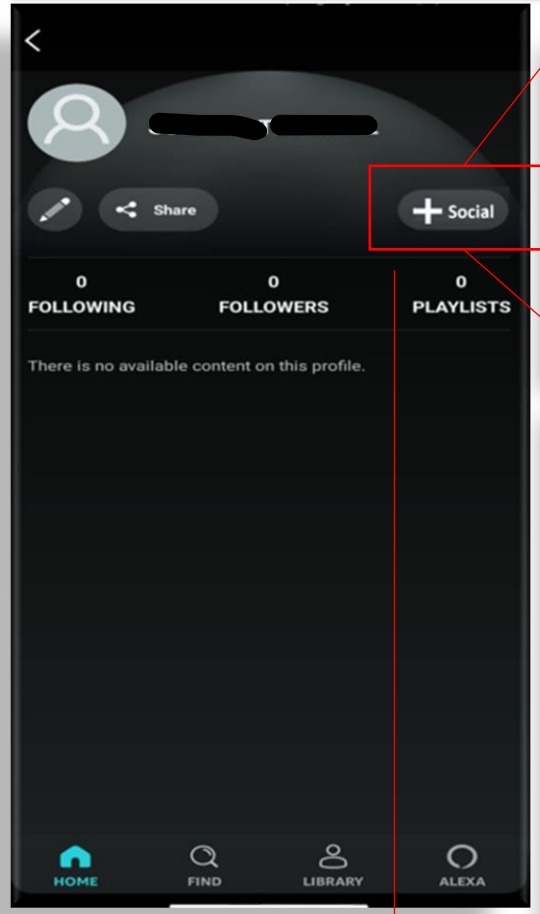
Retention : social media , playlist enhancer

Task Success: Customer Review and feedback

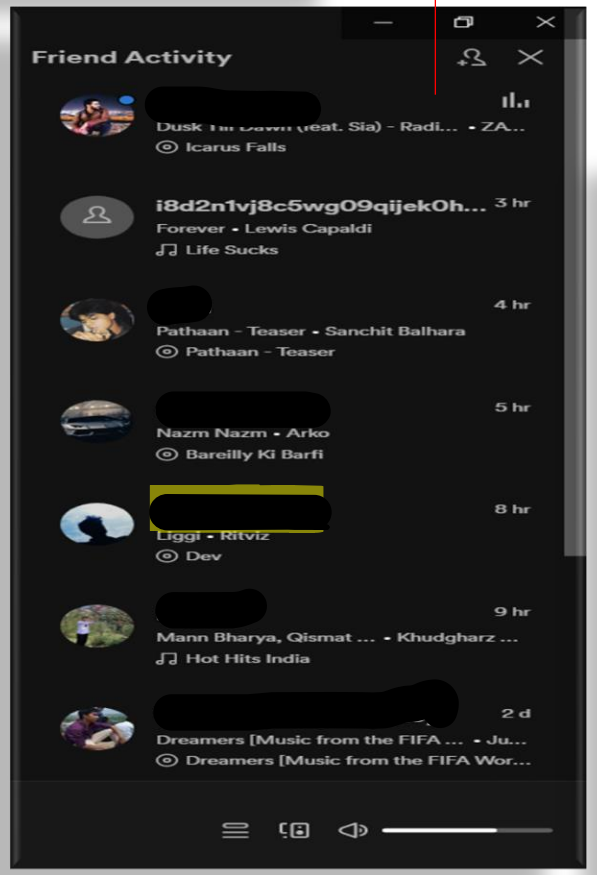
Prototypes

#1 Social Media Connector

Pop up menu after social is clicked



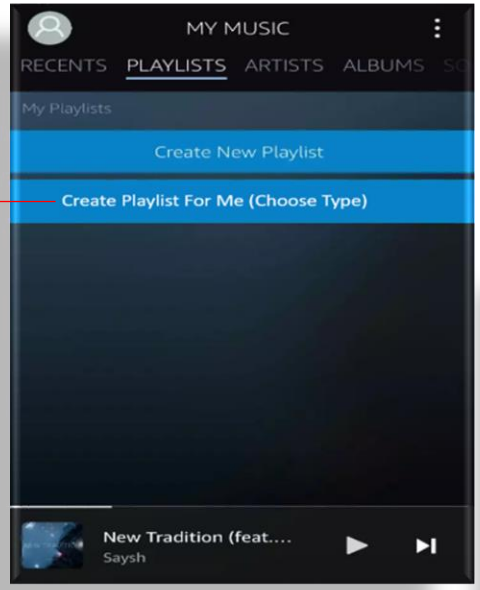
Friend activity tracking bar.



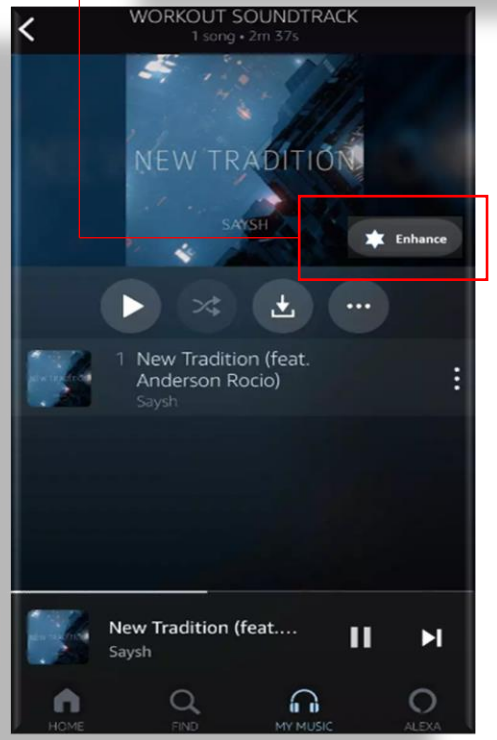
Social button to connect user social media

#2 Playlist Enhancer/Curator

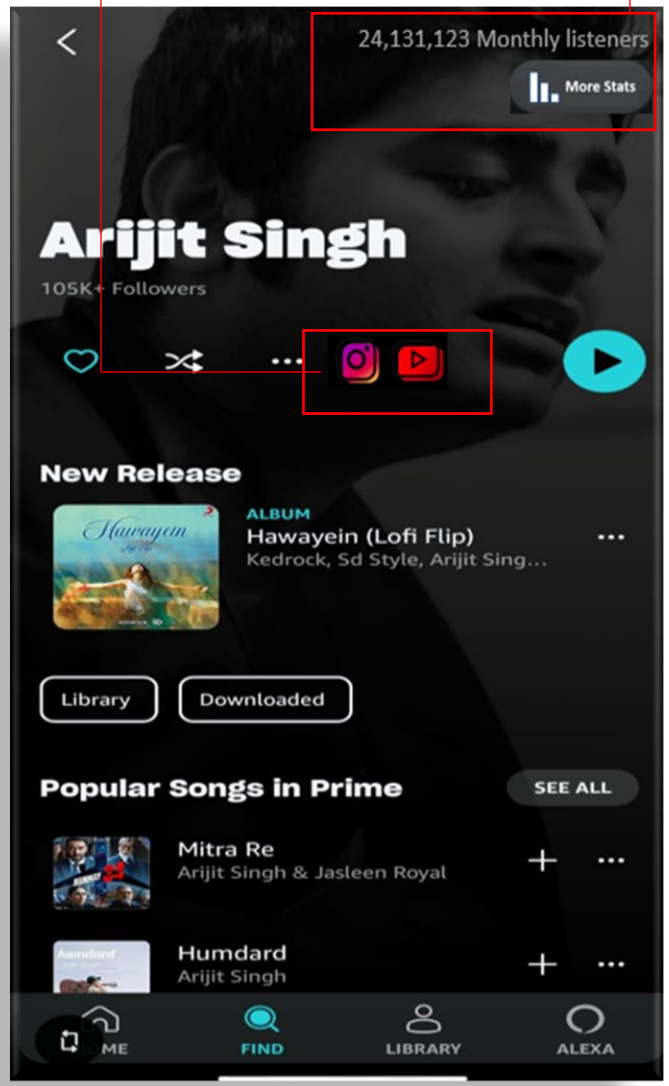
Create playlist automatically button



Enhance playlist button



#3 Artist Music Profile Stats

Links for Artist social media handles/pages

Artist reach stats. More stats button to see detailed stats